

WE4A BUSINESS PITCH

REBLOOM COLLECTIVE

Gender-Based Violence Survivor Rehabilitation & Green Livelihood Training Center

Healing Survivors. Empowering Women. Protecting the Planet.

Kevin Aujo

MPH | BSWASA | Pallisa District, Eastern Uganda

The Problem: A Crisis at Every Level

UGANDA (NATIONAL)

56% of women experience intimate partner violence
23% of girls drop out after menstruation begins

Uganda Bureau of Statistics DHS 2016; UNICEF/Ministry of Education

EASTERN UGANDA

35.7% poverty rate - highest in Uganda
Zero reusable pad manufacturers within 300km

Uganda Bureau of Statistics 2019/20; Market research 2024

BUKEDI SUB-REGION (includes Pallisa)

37.1% sexual violence rate - 123% above national average
58% of Gender-Based Violence (GBV) survivors tell no one

Uganda Bureau of Statistics VAWG Survey 2020

PALLISA DISTRICT

48% of population below poverty line (235,479 people)
61.8% poverty rate in Pallisa County specifically

Pallisa District Statistical Abstract 2018/19

THE DEADLY CYCLE

Women remain in abusive situations due to economic dependence.
Research shows **47%** face economic violence from partners.

"I like him...he's the source of income. If I let him go to prison, I am not going to get any money." - UBOS Focus Group

PERIOD POVERTY IMPACT

28% of girls miss school during menstruation
65% cannot afford menstrual products
85% use cloth/rags instead of pads

Chaturvedi et al., Nature 2020; SNV 2017

The Connection: World Bank confirms improved health product access reduces women's vulnerability to violence

Market Gap: Zero Producers in Eastern Uganda

CRITICAL MARKET FINDING

ZERO

Reusable menstrual pad manufacturers in Bukedi sub-region or Eastern Uganda

NEAREST EXISTING PRODUCERS

AFRIpads (So Sure brand) - Masaka

~300km away (5-6 hours travel)

EcoSmart Pads - Mbarara

~350km away

Days for Girls - Kampala/Jinja

~220km away

OUR OPPORTUNITY

Rebloom Collective will establish the **first local production facility** in Bukedi sub-region, eliminating transport barriers, reducing costs, and creating local employment for women

BUKEDI DEMAND INDICATORS

5,982 GBV cases in Eastern Uganda (2020)

27% increase from 2019

Parliament called for **urgent budget allocation** for menstrual health in Eastern region (June 2024)

UNFPA 2021; CEHURD 2024

CURRENT PALLISA SITUATION

No local production. No consistent supply. Girls resort to unhygienic alternatives causing infections and stigma.

No MHM programs identified specifically operating in Pallisa District

Our Solution: Three Integrated Components

COMPONENT 1

GBV Survivor Rehabilitation

Safe space with psychosocial support, counseling, peer groups, life skills training, and vocational development

Breaking the cycle of economic dependence

COMPONENT 2

Rebloom Pad Manufacturing

First local production of reusable menstrual pads in Teso.
Survivors trained as producers earning dignified income

Creating economic independence

COMPONENT 3

CHE Distribution Network

Community Health Entrepreneurs (CHEs) distribute Rebloom Pads across Pallisa, earning commission while providing health education

Building sustainable livelihoods

GRADUATION PATHWAY: GBV Survivor → Trained Producer → Community Health Entrepreneur (CHE) → Independent Business Owner

SURVIVORS

Heal, train, produce, become entrepreneurs

GIRLS

Stay in school with affordable Rebloom Pads

WOMEN

CHEs earn sustainable commission income

ENVIRONMENT

Protected from 500+ year plastic waste

The Journey: From Survivor to Entrepreneur



Complete Transformation: Crisis → Healing → Skills → Employment → Entrepreneurship → Independence

16 weeks

Core rehabilitation

3 pathways

Producer, CHE, or own business

Ongoing

Mentorship and support

Key: CHW = Community Health Worker | VSLA = Village Savings and Loan Association | CHE = Community Health Entrepreneur

Rebloom Pads: Green Health for Communities

REBLOOM PAD KIT

Kit of 4 pads, lasts 2-3 years

UGX 15,000

~\$4 USD | 70% cheaper than disposables

- Soft cotton flannel outer layer
- Highly absorbent core
- Waterproof backing
- Secure snap fasteners
- Easy to wash and dry

ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT

500+ years

Time for 1 disposable pad to decompose

200+

Disposables prevented per Rebloom Pad

97%

Reduction in solid waste vs. disposables

Rheinländer et al., Science of Total Environment 2020

EXPANDED GREEN HEALTH PRODUCTS (Year 2+)

Eco-Soap Bars

Natural ingredients, plastic-free, locally handmade

Herbal Remedies

Traditional medicine, sustainably sourced

Water Purification

Affordable filters for safe drinking water

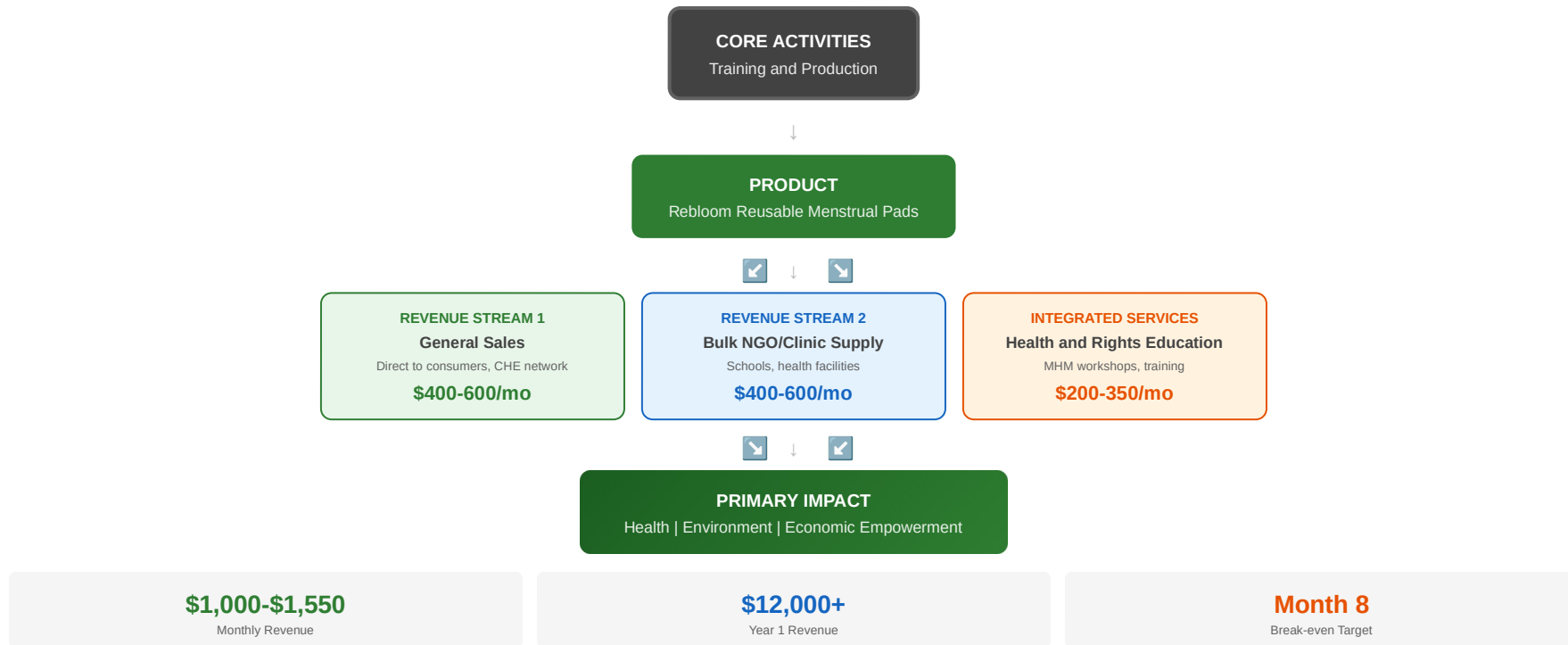
Natural Repellents

Plant-based mosquito protection

COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

First and only local producer in Teso sub-region. No transport costs from Kampala/Masaka. Direct community relationships.

Business Model: Training to Impact



Culturally Rooted: Community-Led Approach

LOCAL LANGUAGE DELIVERY

All training, counseling, and MHM education delivered in **Ateso** and **Lugwere** - the primary languages of Pallisa District and Bukedi sub-region

TRADITIONAL LEADERSHIP INTEGRATION

Working with **clan elders**, **LC leaders**, and **religious leaders** as program ambassadors

RESPECTING TRADITIONAL PRACTICES

MHM education builds on existing cultural knowledge. Peer-to-peer approach: CHEs from same communities they serve

COMMUNITY-LED DESIGN

Advisory board includes local women leaders, health workers, and GBV survivors to guide program decisions

WHY THIS MATTERS

58% of Bukedi GBV survivors tell no one about their abuse

This is the **highest silence rate** in Uganda. Breaking this silence requires cultural sensitivity and trusted local voices.

KEVIN'S LOCAL ADVANTAGE

- **Native Ateso speaker**
- **Fluent in Lugwere and Luganda**
- **Born in Kumi District**
- **Established CHW relationships**

Community Health Entrepreneur (CHE) Network

THE MODEL: LAST-MILE DISTRIBUTION

Community Health Entrepreneurs (CHEs) are trained women who distribute Rebloom Pads and green health products door-to-door, earning **20-25% commission** on every sale while providing Menstrual Hygiene Management (MHM) education in Ateso and Lugwere

CHE BENEFITS

For CHEs

- 20-25% commission on sales
- Flexible work from home
- Business training provided
- Starter kit worth UGX 200,000

For Communities

- Products at their doorstep
- Health education included
- Affordable local prices
- Trusted neighbor as source

SURVIVOR-TO-CHE PATHWAY

Gender-Based Violence (GBV) survivors who complete rehabilitation can graduate to become CHEs, receiving starter kit and ongoing mentorship. This creates complete economic independence - breaking the cycle of abuse.

PALLISA DISTRICT ADVANTAGE

Leveraging Kevin's existing Community Health Worker (CHW) network from Baylor-Uganda:

- Peer mothers network
- Case management assistants
- Health facility connections
- Established trust relationships

YEAR 1 CHE TARGETS

25

Active CHEs

50+

Villages reached

Inspired by Solar Sister and Avon models proven in rural Africa

Year 1 Impact Projections

50+

GBV Survivors

Completing rehabilitation

15+

Jobs Created

Producers and staff

25

Active CHEs

Earning commission income

750+

Girls Reached

With affordable Rebloom Pads

ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT

150,000+ 750+ kg

Disposables prevented

Plastic waste diverted

Each disposable pad takes 500+ years to decompose (Rheinländer et al., 2020)

ADDITIONAL METRICS

50+

Villages covered

3,000+

School days saved

2,000+

Households served

\$12K+

Year 1 revenue

Every survivor rehabilitated can become a producer | Every producer can become a CHE entrepreneur

FIRST IN BUKEDI: Rebloom Collective will establish the first local reusable menstrual pad production facility in Bukedi sub-region

Why I Will Succeed: My Competitive Advantage



Kevin Aujo

Kumi District, Eastern Uganda

CREDENTIALS

Master of Public Health (MPH)

Uganda Martyrs University (UMU)

Bachelor of Social Work and Social Administration (BSWASA)

Kyambogo University

Native Ateso speaker

Fluent: Lugwere, Luganda, English

GBV Support Experience

Counseling Gender-Based Violence survivors at Pallisa shelter under Probation and Welfare Office. Community dialogues and district GBV coordination.

Adolescent Health Educator

Trained Peer Educator on Adolescent Sexual and Reproductive Health (ASRH) through Naguru Teenage Centre. MHM education expertise.

Data and Quality Improvement

Strong data management skills. Quality Improvement project leadership for tracking impact and reporting results to funders.

CHW Network Access

Current Baylor-Uganda Case Management Officer supervising peer mothers and Community Health Workers. Ready-made CHE recruitment pipeline.

Community Mobilization

Proven track record organizing youth, women, and vulnerable groups across multiple districts in Eastern Uganda.

Health Systems Training

Specialized training: Building Resilient Health Systems through Community Health Worker (CHW) strengthening.

Unique Combination: Public Health + GBV expertise + CHW networks + Local language + Community trust = Competitive moat that outside organizations cannot match

The Ask: \$5,000 WE4A Seed Capital

WHAT \$5,000 WILL FUND

\$1,300 Production equipment

\$1,100 GBV center setup

\$1,000 CHE network launch

\$900 Raw materials

\$700 Operations

YEAR 1 IMPACT SUMMARY

50+

GBV survivors

15+

Jobs created

750+

Girls reached

150K+

Disposables prevented

FINANCIAL VIABILITY

\$14,460

Year 1 revenue

Month 8

Break-even

289%

ROI



Kevin Aujo

MPH - Uganda Martyrs University

BSWASA - Kyambogo University

Pallisa District, Eastern Uganda

FIRST PRODUCER IN BUKEDI SUB-REGION

Zero competitors within 300km

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THE ASK

\$5,000 WE4A Seed Capital

With this investment, in Year 1 Rebloom Collective will deliver:

50+

GBV survivors

15+

Jobs created

25

CHE
entrepreneurs

750+

Girls in school

150K+

Waste prevented

FIRST LOCAL PRODUCER of reusable menstrual pads in Teso sub-region

REBLOOM COLLECTIVE

Where Survivors Heal, Women Thrive, and Communities Flourish

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